

Friday, 23 January 2026

From Dwarssloop to the Cockpit: A Pilot's Dream

*Lebogang Moore Phoku.*

At just 23 years old, Lebogang Moore Phoku is already defying expectations — not only as a qualified commercial pilot, but as a symbol of possibility for young people growing up in rural communities.

Born and raised in Dwarssloop, Bushbuckridge in Mpumalanga, Lebogang's fascination with aviation began long before he understood what it took to become a

pilot. In a community far removed from airports and flight schools, aeroplanes were a rare but magical sight.

"Growing up in a small community, seeing airplanes pass overhead was something special," he recalls.

"Every time I looked up and saw one crossing the sky, I felt excitement and curiosity. I didn't fully understand how they worked,

but I knew deep down that I wanted to be part of that world one day."

After completing matric, Lebogang made the bold decision to pursue aviation — a path few from his background had walked before. With determination and faith in his dream, he began flight training, a journey that would test his resilience in ways he never imagined.

Earning his Private Pilot Licence marked a turning point. "It confirmed that this was more than just a dream — it was my purpose," he says. "From that point on, there was no turning back."

He later completed his Commercial Pilot Licence at the prestigious 43 Air School, where the demands were intense, both mentally and physically. The experience required discipline, sacrifice and unwavering commitment, shaping him not only into a capable pilot, but a stronger individual.

Today, Lebogang is focused on building his flight hours, taking every opportunity to get into the cockpit. "Every flight teaches me something new and reminds me why I started this journey," he says. "Despite the challenges, I remain motivated and grateful. Becoming a pilot has been one of the most rewarding experiences of my life."

However, his journey has not been smooth or straightforward. Coming from a background with no exposure

to aviation, no industry connections and no clear roadmap, Lebogang had to navigate the world of flying largely on his own, relying on determination, supportive instructors and personal effort.

One of the most devastating moments came with the loss of his uncle, Jayson Mokone — a man who was not only family, but his greatest supporter and the person funding his training. His uncle's passing in a tragic accident left Lebogang emotionally shattered and financially strained, bringing his aviation journey to an uncertain standstill.

"It affected me deeply," he says. "There were moments when giving up felt like the easier option."

Yet, even in grief and uncertainty, Lebogang chose resilience. The setbacks strengthened his resolve and reminded him why he had started chasing the skies in the first place.

Today, his story stands as a powerful reminder that dreams are valid — no matter where you come from. From the skies above Dwarssloop to the runways of South Africa's flight schools, Lebogang Phoku's journey is one of courage, perseverance and unwavering belief.

And for many young people looking up as planes pass overhead, his story proves that sometimes, the sky is not the limit — it's only the beginning.

Learner
Fatally
Stabbed by
Fellow
Student



Healing at the
Crossroads of
Tradition and
Modern
Medicine



Kaizer Chiefs
End Winless
Run with
Narrow Victory



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SPIRITUAL REBIRTH

Lineage of a King: The Genealogy of Jesus Begins Jerusalem

The Gospel of Matthew opens with a detailed record tracing the ancestry of Jesus Christ. Presented as both the son of David and son of Abraham, the genealogy establishes Jesus' legal and prophetic lineage.

The record begins with Abraham, the father of the Hebrew nation, and moves through key patriarchs—Isaac, Jacob, and Judah. Notably, women are included in this lineage, which was uncommon in ancient records. Tamar, Rahab, and Ruth—each with distinct and difficult pasts—are mentioned, signalling that God's plan often includes unexpected people.

From Judah's line came Perez, Hezron, and eventually Jesse, the father of King David. David, revered as Israel's greatest king, is listed as the father of Solomon, through "Uriah's wife," referencing the complicated story of Bathsheba.

This portion of the genealogy lays a foundation for Jesus' royal and redemptive identity, highlighting God's faithfulness across generations. The inclusion of both saints and sinners in the family tree points to a Messiah who came for all.

Flood Relief Efforts Intensified in Provinces



Providing an update on Wednesday, Minister of Human Settlements Thembi Simelane said fatalities in Limpopo have increased from 17 to 18, with six people still missing across Limpopo and Mpumalanga.

Government has stepped up interventions to assist communities affected by recent floods in Mpumalanga and Limpopo, as the death toll rises and thousands of homes remain damaged.

Providing an update on Wednesday, Minister of Human Settlements Thembi Simelane said fatalities in Limpopo have increased from 17 to 18, with six people still missing across Limpopo and Mpumalanga. In Mpumalanga, the number of people who have lost their lives due to flooding now stands at 20.

The floods, caused by persistent heavy rainfall, have left widespread destruction in both provinces. According to the Department of Human Settlements, at least 1 942 houses have been damaged in Limpopo, while 1 808 homes were recorded as affected in Mpumalanga. Many families have been displaced and are currently staying in mass care or evacuation centres.

Minister Simelane acknowledged that ongoing adverse weather conditions, particularly in Limpopo, have made relief operations challenging. She explained that the verification process to assess the full extent of damage is critical, as it guides the type of emergency housing assistance to be provided. Despite the difficulties, the department has made significant progress in verifying affected households.

While assessments continue, the department has begun assisting families whose homes have already been verified as damaged. The first phase includes the procurement of Temporary Emergency Accommodation (TEA) for households currently housed in evacuation centres.

This will be followed by the rollout of Temporary Residential Units (TRUs) to provide safer and more stable shelter.

A total of 130 TRUs are being procured for affected areas, including 73 units earmarked for Bushbuckridge, 39 for Mbaula, 13 for Makhado and five for Blouberg. These units are intended to provide immediate relief while longer-term housing solutions are planned.

Minister Simelane confirmed that she, together with the MECs for Human Settlements in Limpopo and Mpumalanga, will be on the ground over the next two days to oversee interventions and ensure that communities receive the necessary support.

She extended heartfelt condolences to families who have lost loved ones and expressed gratitude to community members, churches and non-governmental organisations for their continued assistance to affected households. "Your support during this difficult time is highly appreciated," she said, adding that government will continue to roll out interventions as verification processes are completed.



CRIME
Learner Fatally Stabbed by Fellow Student



A tragic incident at LD Moetanalo Secondary School in Steve Tshwete Circuit 1 has left a 19-year-old Grade 11 learner dead. The incident occurred on Tuesday, 20 January 2026, while learners were changing classes. Reports indicate that an argument between learners escalated into a physical confrontation during which the victim was allegedly stabbed.

Emergency medical personnel were called to the scene but sadly certified the learner deceased. School management acted swiftly by notifying the learner's parents and reporting the matter to the South African Police Service (SAPS). Police investigations are ongoing, with a fellow learner reportedly involved and being sought by authorities.

In a related update, police confirmed that a 20-year-old Grade 10 learner, allegedly involved in the altercation, was arrested and is expected to appear at Middelburg Magistrate's Court. The Acting Provincial Commissioner of SAPS, Major General (Dr) Zeph Mkhwanazi, strongly condemned the act, stating that violence on school premises is unacceptable and urging communities, parents, and learners to collaborate with law enforcement to prevent such tragedies.

The Mpumalanga Department of Education has expressed shock and sadness over the loss, emphasising the importance of safe learning environments and condemning all acts of violence that threaten the wellbeing of learners and staff.

Healing at the Crossroads of Tradition and Modern Medicine



Elizabeth Baas director of lesaka ladinaga.

In the heart of Bushbuckridge, where ancestral wisdom meets the realities of modern healthcare, Lesaka La Dingaka stands as a powerful force uniting tradition, faith and science in service of humanity. Established in 2007, the non-profit organisation has become a respected voice advocating for collaboration between Traditional Health Practitioners (THPs), faith-based healers and Western medical practitioners, ensuring that no community member is left behind in the journey towards wellness.

For many rural families, traditional healers remain the first point of contact in times of illness, distress or uncertainty. Recognising this reality, Lesaka La Dingaka was formed with a clear mission: to organise, educate and regulate THPs, while building strong working relationships with clinics, hospitals and government departments, particularly the Department of Health (DoH).

Leadership Rooted in Ancestral Calling

At the centre of this movement is Dr MN Mnisi, the Mpumalanga Coordinator of Lesaka La Dingaka, a respected traditional health practitioner born and raised in Xanthia Village, Bushbuckridge. Dr Mnisi’s journey into traditional healing began in 2010, when he was initiated at Cork Trust under the guidance of the well-known Gobela Mpandezithi Mavis Mhangane. His work reflects a deep understanding of both ancestral responsibility and contemporary healthcare challenges, making him a key bridge between communities and formal health systems.

Guiding the organisation at national level is Elizabeth Baas, the Director of Lesaka La Dingaka, whose roots in traditional healing run deep. Baas was initiated in 1989 by one of Mpumalanga’s most revered traditional healers, Nyoniyezwe Mkhabela.

Mkhabela, born on 16 April 1918, was initiated in 1974 and, remarkably, is still alive, actively practising, consulting and training amathwasa. Widely regarded as one of the “big bosses” of traditional healing in Mpumalanga, hee legacy lives on through the generations she continues to mentor, including leaders shaping the future of Lesaka La Dingaka.

Bridging Two Worlds of Healing

Lesaka La Dingaka’s work is firmly grounded in education and patient safety. One of its core objectives is to train Traditional Health Practitioners to identify conditions that require urgent medical attention and to confidently refer patients to clinics and hospitals when necessary. This approach has helped reduce delays in treatment and strengthened trust between traditional and Western health systems.

The organisation also plays a critical role in educating both practitioners and communities about the dangers of toxic and unregulated medicines, promoting responsible healing practices that protect lives.

A strong advocate for the legal recognition and regulation of THPs, Lesaka La Dingaka works to ensure practitioners operate within

clear rules and ethical standards. The organisation believes that traditional healing should be recognised by government structures and properly regulated, while remaining rooted in African spirituality and culture.

Healing Beyond Medicine

Understanding that health is deeply connected to social conditions, Lesaka La Dingaka extends its work beyond medical issues. The organisation provides psycho-social referrals, linking individuals and families to professional support services when facing trauma, mental health challenges or social distress.

Its compassion is also felt through practical acts of care. Lesaka La Dingaka provides meals to orphaned and vulnerable children, as well as destitute community members, offering relief to households struggling with poverty and food insecurity.

Through home visits, the organisation reaches the elderly, the ill and those unable to access formal services, ensuring dignity, support and human connection.

Championing Social Awareness and Prevention

In response to rising social challenges, Lesaka La Dingaka actively promotes a drug-free environment and campaigns against substance abuse. Through community dialogues, education and

life-skills programmes, the organisation addresses critical issues including HIV and AIDS, TB, STIs, cancer and mental health.

These discussions are conducted in culturally sensitive ways that resonate with communities, helping to break stigma, encourage early intervention and promote healthier lifestyles.

Strengthening Unity Among Healers

To enhance coordination and accountability, Lesaka La Dingaka is working on building a database of Traditional Health Practitioners and hosting regular meetings. These platforms allow healers to share knowledge, align practices and strengthen cooperation with the Western healthcare system.

A Living Legacy of Healing

Lesaka La Dingaka is more than an organisation – it is a living legacy of ancestral wisdom, leadership and service. Guided by elders who have walked the healing path for decades and led by practitioners committed to ethical, regulated and compassionate care, the organisation continues to reshape how healthcare is understood and delivered in rural communities.

In Bushbuckridge and across Mpumalanga, Lesaka La Dingaka remains a symbol of unity, reminding us that true healing happens when tradition and modern medicine walk side by side.



MN mnisi and proff Nyoniyezwe.

Flood Disaster Triggers Emergency EXCO



The Mpumalanga Provincial Government Executive Council (EXCO), led by Premier Mandla Ndlovu, has convened an emergency meeting following severe weather conditions that have caused widespread damage across the province.

In a statement issued on 21 January 2026, the Executive Council expressed deep concern over persistent heavy rains that have resulted in flooding, destruction of infrastructure, disruption of essential services and loss of life. Areas hardest hit include the Nkomazi and Bushbuckridge municipalities, where homes have been damaged, provincial roads destroyed and school programmes, water supply and electricity services interrupted.

EXCO emphasised the urgent need to strengthen disaster management teams to ensure immediate support for affected families. This includes evacuations, provision of temporary shelter and humanitarian relief during disasters.

Premier Ndlovu indicated that the province must review and fully implement its Climate Change Strategy to improve both preventative and reactive measures, while also strengthening coordination between government departments and stakeholders during disasters.

He extended heartfelt condolences to families who have lost loved ones, stating that every life lost is a profound tragedy. The Premier assured residents that government remains committed to continued and proactive interventions.

All relevant departments have been instructed to intensify coordinated response measures, fast-track damage assessments and speed up the restoration of services to communities across Mpumalanga.

During the meeting, the Department of Cooperative Governance, Human Settlements and Traditional Affairs (CoGHSTA) presented a provincial disaster overview. Since the start of the summer season, Mpumalanga has recorded 20 fatalities, including 18 drownings, one lightning-related death and one death caused by a structural wall collapse. All bodies have been recovered. The estimated cost of repairing damaged infrastructure is expected to exceed R3.5 billion.

Although all districts have been affected, the Ehlanzeni District Municipality has experienced the greatest impact, with 1,808 houses reported as damaged. EXCO commended CoGHSTA for implementing the Provincial Flood Management Strategy,

noting that the damage could have been far worse without these measures.

The Executive Council also noted that the National Disaster Management Centre has declared the situation a National State of Disaster, which includes Mpumalanga Province. Implementing agents and service providers have been urged to ensure accountability and value for money in all

rebuilding efforts. In other developments, EXCO approved key administrative appointments, including Dr Mohau Armatto Ramodibe as Chief Director: Corporate Services in the Department of Economic Development and Tourism, and Ms Phumzile Sipiwe Khoza as Chief Financial Officer in the Department of Culture, Sports and Recreation.



Crocodile Bridge Gate to Reopen After Floods

Following recent severe weather in parts of Limpopo and Mpumalanga, including areas within Kruger National Park (KNP), Crocodile Bridge Gate will reopen for day visitors from Thursday, 22 January 2026.

Visitors are warned that conditions remain unpredictable. A dam wall outside the park has been reported as compromised, which could lead to sudden changes in access at Crocodile Bridge Gate. All gravel roads remain closed, and guests are strongly advised not to remove barricades, which are in place to protect public safety and park infrastructure.



Malelane, Numbi, and Paul Kruger Gates remain open under an entry quota system, while Phabeni Gate stays closed. However, the southern and northern sections of the park are still cut off, making Tshokwane Picnic Site, Satara Rest Camp, and northern areas inaccessible.

SANParks continues to monitor the situation and urges visitors to follow all instructions and signage for their safety. Guests are also encouraged to take their waste with them as operations remain under pressure following the flooding.

Police probe discovery of two bodies near Lily Mine

Police have launched an investigation following the discovery of two deceased men near Lily Mine in Low's Creek on Tuesday morning.

According to a media statement issued by the Office of the Provincial Commissioner, police received information at about 7am regarding two men who were suspected to be dead in the area. Officers responded to the scene together with Emergency Medical Services.



On arrival, the men were found covered with blankets and were both certified dead at the scene.

One of the deceased has since been positively identified by a relative, who confirmed that the man was his brother and that they originate from the Kingdom of Eswatini. Police are still working to establish the identity of the second deceased male and to locate his family.

The circumstances surrounding the deaths are currently under investigation, and police have not yet released further details.

Members of the public who may have information that could assist the investigation, or who know the relatives of the unidentified deceased, are urged to contact Crime Stop on 08600 10111. Information can also be submitted via the MySAPS App. Police have assured the public that all information will be treated with the strictest confidentiality, and callers may remain anonymous.

Floods Leave Scars, Hope Emerges



Heavy rains have left a trail of grief and destruction across Mpumalanga and Limpopo, turning once-familiar villages into scenes of loss, uncertainty and resilience.

In Bushbuckridge and neighbouring areas, families are still counting the cost as floodwaters recede, revealing damaged homes, shattered belongings and lives forever changed.

According to an update delivered this week by Minister of Human Settlements, Thembi Simelane, the human toll continues to rise. Limpopo has now recorded 18 fatalities, with six people still missing across Limpopo and Mpumalanga. In Mpumalanga alone, 20 lives have been lost. Behind each number

is a story of a family waiting for answers, a community mourning one of its own.

The physical damage is just as stark. In Limpopo, 1 942 houses have been damaged, while Mpumalanga has recorded 1 808 affected homes. Many of these are mud structures in rural villages, which stood little chance against relentless rains. For families who had already been living on the margins, the floods have deepened hardship and exposed long-standing vulnerabilities.

Government teams are now racing against time and weather conditions to bring relief. Verification processes are under way to assess the extent of damage and determine appropriate assistance. Despite

difficult conditions, the Department of Human Settlements has begun moving ahead with support for households already verified.

Temporary Emergency Accommodation is being procured for families currently housed in evacuation and mass care centres. In a move that brings some relief closer to home, 73 Temporary Residential Units have been earmarked for Bushbuckridge, with additional units planned for Mbaula, Blouberg and Makhado.

These structures are expected to offer affected families a measure of safety and dignity while longer-term solutions are developed.

Over the coming days, national and provincial leaders will be on the ground in

both provinces, working alongside local authorities to ensure aid reaches those who need it most.

Yet, amid the devastation, there have been powerful moments of solidarity. Churches, community groups and NGOs have opened their doors, shared food, offered shelter and reminded many that they are not alone.

As floodwaters fade from the roads and fields, the real work begins: rebuilding homes, restoring hope and ensuring communities are better protected against future disasters.

For Bushbuckridge and many other towns, recovery will take time, but resilience, compassion and collective effort are already lighting the way forward.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

TO : THE PUBLIC

SUBJECT : WATER SUPPLY INTERRUPTION DUE TO POWER OUTAGE AT INYAKA

WTW AND RAW WATER PUMP STATION

DATE : 22 JANUARY 2026

REF : 10/2/1/1

Inyaka Water Treatment Works as well as Raw water Pump station are experiencing power outage, affecting maximum water production and distribution to the community. The fault has been reported to Eskom and normal water supply will resume immediately the electricity is restored.

Affected areas are: Bushbuckridge CBD, College View, Mapulaneng Hospital, Masana, Mountain View, Mphenyatsatsi, Thulamahashe, Ludlow, Agincourt, Marite, Rolle, Acomhoek, Dwarsloop, Shatale, Casteel and the surrounding areas.

Social Media handles

Twitter : @Bbr municipality

Facebook : Bushbuckridge Municipality

ISSUED BY THE MUNICIPAL MANAGER

BLM COMMUNICATIONS

NOTICE NUMBER: 22/01/2026/81

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EXTERNAL NOTICE

TO : THE PUBLIC

SUBJECT : WATER SUPPLY INTERRUPTION

DATE : 19 JANUARY 2026

REF : 10/2/1/1

Kindly be informed of water supply interruption at Inyaka Water Treatment Works and Raw Water Pump Station due to power failure. Affected areas are Mapulaneng, Hospital, Mphenyatsatsi, College View, Mountain View, Bushbuckridge CBD, Shangaan Hill, Agincourt, Marite, Acomhoek, Thulamahashe, Dwarsloop, Ludlow, Hluvukani, Boikhutso, Masakeng, Shatale, Xanthia, MP Stream, Sibambayani, Casteel, and Rolle.

The matter has been reported to Eskom and water supply will resume once Eskom restores power supply at the affected stations. The municipality apologizes for the inconvenience the situation has caused.

Social Media handles

X (formerly twitter): @Bbr municipality

Facebook: Bushbuckridge Municipality

ISSUED BY THE MUNICIPAL MANAGER

BLM COMMUNICATIONS

NOTICE NUMBER: 19/01/2026/79

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MEC Assesses Flood Damage to Farms

The Mpumalanga Department of Agriculture, Rural Development and Land Affairs has begun assessing the impact of recent heavy rainfall on agricultural projects across the province, starting with affected farms in the Mkhondo Local Municipality.

MEC Khethiwe Moeketsi recently conducted a site visit to evaluate flood-related damage, engage with affected farmers and facilitate a coordinated government response. She was accompanied by the Mkhondo MMC for Finance as well as senior officials from the department.

During the visit, the delegation inspected three agricultural projects that were severely affected by the adverse weather conditions, namely Mandlangampisi, Madabukela and Ogenyaneni farms. These projects had previously received departmental support, including vegetable tunnels, Smart Agricultural Boxes and seedlings aimed at improving production and food security.

Addressing farmers on site, MEC Moeketsi said the visit marked the start of a province-wide assessment process. She confirmed that similar evaluations would be conducted in other districts impacted by flooding and excessive rainfall. Comprehensive assessment reports will be compiled to determine the full extent of the damage before long-term interventions are implemented.



As an immediate relief measure, the MEC handed over vegetable seedlings to affected farmers to enable them to resume production and mitigate income losses. She said the short-term support was critical to ensuring continued food production while the department finalises longer-term assistance.

Moeketsi further indicated that sustainable relief measures would be rolled out once disaster relief funding becomes available. "The department remains committed to supporting affected farmers and ensuring that agricultural production is restored," she said.

The department has also issued advisory guidelines to assist farmers during periods

of flooding. These include maintaining clean and functional drainage systems, planting crops on higher ground where possible, implementing contour ploughing or terracing on slopes, and avoiding the application of fertilisers during heavy rainfall due to high nutrient loss.

Farmers have been cautioned to remain alert to the increased risk of pests and diseases following prolonged wet conditions, and to treat floodwater as potentially hazardous to both humans and livestock.

Communities are encouraged to monitor weather warnings issued through official media platforms and to prioritise safety during severe weather events.



UMP, UMES Strengthen Experiential Learning Partnership



The University of Mpumalanga (UMP) recently hosted a two-week student exchange programme with the University of Maryland Eastern Shore (UMES), USA, at its Mbombela Campus from 6 to 20 January 2026.

The programme culminated in a seminar where visiting students reflected on the skills and experiences gained, spanning cultural, social, and practical learning.



This exchange is part of a 2023 Memorandum of Understanding between the two universities, aimed at promoting innovative agricultural research, student and staff exchanges, sustainable business growth, and economic development.

Deputy Vice-Chancellor Professor Moses Mbewe highlighted the potential for long-term research collaboration and ‘sandwich’ programmes enabling students to study at both institutions. UMES Assistant Professor Abiodun Omotayo praised the hands-on approach for addressing real-world challenges, while UMES student Aseel Awad described the programme as providing valuable insights into financial sustainability and farm management.

Professor Funso Kutu, Head of UMP’s School of Agricultural Sciences, said the initiative demonstrates both universities’ commitment to experiential learning and collaborative research.



The Mpumalanga Economic Growth Agency (MEGA) has expressed deep concern for residents, families, and businesses affected by the recent severe floods across the province.

The extreme weather has damaged key infrastructure, including roads, bridges, and transport routes, disrupting trade and supply chains for agriculture, retail, and industry.

Hundreds of kilometres of road networks are affected, temporarily blocking access to important markets and slowing economic activity. Homes, businesses, and public facilities have also suffered significant damage.

MEGA CEO Isaac Mahlangu said the agency is committed to supporting recovery efforts, including restoring infrastructure, market access, and affected enterprises. He emphasised collaboration with government, private sector partners, and communities to minimise long-term economic impacts.

MEGA acknowledged President Cyril Ramaphosa’s visit to Nkomazi, highlighting national support for recovery, and praised disaster management teams and volunteers for their tireless efforts. Mahlangu urged stakeholders to focus on safety, resilience, and rebuilding, noting that together the province’s economy can be restored in a sustainable and inclusive manner.

Border Security Is Everyone’s Duty



Every festive season, Mpumalanga becomes a gateway — not only for holidaymakers and returning families, but also for a growing number of undocumented foreign nationals entering South Africa illegally through porous borders. While government routinely assures the public of “heightened security”, communities on the ground experience a very different reality: overwhelmed clinics, overcrowded schools, strained housing, and law enforcement stretched beyond capacity.

ActionSA is deeply concerned by the scale of illegal border crossings into Mpumalanga, particularly during peak travel periods. This is not a theoretical policy debate; it is a lived crisis in towns and villages across our province. It speaks directly to the erosion of border control, the weakening of the rule of law, and the persistent failure of coordination between

the Department of Home Affairs, the South African Police Service, the Defence Force, and provincial authorities.

There is also a dangerous misconception that illegal foreign nationals primarily enter South Africa through official ports of entry. This is simply not true. Those who pass through border posts such as Lebombo do so legally. They present documentation, are processed, and are granted lawful entry for a stipulated period.

It is only when some overstay beyond that timeframe that they become undocumented. Those who enter illegally do so elsewhere — through unguarded stretches of the border, informal crossings, and routes well known to syndicates and smugglers. Conflating these realities distorts public understanding and shifts blame away from the state’s failure to

secure the border itself.

Border security is not optional in a constitutional democracy. A state that cannot account for who enters and remains within its territory cannot plan, govern, or protect its citizens effectively. Yet year after year, South Africans are asked to accept dysfunction as an inevitability rather than a failure that must be corrected.

Law enforcement alone cannot defeat this crisis. However, law enforcement supported by functioning institutions and an active, responsive citizenry can make a decisive difference. Public institutions — particularly in health, education, and social services — cannot remain passive observers. When undocumented individuals present themselves at clinics, schools, or municipal offices seeking assistance, these institutions also carry a responsibility to uphold the law. Reporting unlawful presence to the relevant authorities is not cruelty; it is governance. It is how a state maintains order while still acting humanely.

Silence and inaction place an unfair burden on already overstretched resources. Every unrecorded patient, unaccounted learner, and unmonitored settlement stretches systems that are already failing South Africans. Communities end up competing for services that were never designed to

absorb unlimited demand, breeding resentment, instability, and social fracture.

This is not a call for vigilantism or hostility. It is a call for responsibility.

South Africans must work together to curb the scourge of illegal immigration within our borders. A functioning state depends not only on police officers and soldiers, but on institutions that act lawfully and citizens who understand that order is a shared obligation. Reporting unlawful presence to the appropriate authorities is part of that civic duty.

A country governed by laws cannot selectively enforce them. Compassion without control becomes collapse. Sovereignty without enforcement becomes fiction.

Mpumalanga’s borders are not merely provincial lines; they are the frontline of South Africa’s constitutional order. If we continue to tolerate dysfunction at these gateways, we will continue to pay for it in our clinics, classrooms, and communities.

According to ActionSA South Africa can be both humane and lawful. But it begins with a simple truth: borders must mean something, institutions must act, and citizens must no longer be expected to carry the cost of state failure in silence.



Kaizer Chiefs End Winless Run with Narrow Victory

Kaizer Chiefs began 2026 on a winning note, edging past Golden Arrows 1-0 thanks to an Aden McCarthy header in the 38th minute. The result ends a four-match winless streak for the Soweto giants, who had previously lost 2-1 to Al-Masry in the CAF Confederation Cup and drawn against Zamalek (1-1), Chippa United (0-0) and TS Galaxy (0-0).

Amakhosi made several changes to the starting line-up, introducing Thabiso Monyane, Aden McCarthy, Siphesihle Ndlovu, Pule Mmodi and Glody Lilepo. The

new midfield pairing of Lebohang Maboe and Ndlovu controlled play early, keeping Arrows pinned in their own half.

Kaizer Chiefs dominated the first half, creating several chances before the breakthrough. Maboe's dangerous in-swinging free-kick saw the goalkeeper spill the ball, allowing McCarthy to react quickest and nod home for a deserved 1-0 lead.

After the break, Golden Arrows enjoyed more possession but struggled to create



clear opportunities, with Chiefs' defence remaining solid. Flavio Silva and Siyanda Ndlovu wasted chances, while Arrows' Ndlovu hit the post in a tense 71st minute. Chiefs held on to secure all three points, moving up to third place, just two points behind leaders Mamelodi Sundowns.

Kaizer Chiefs now turn their attention to continental football, travelling to Zambia to face Zesco United in the CAF Confederation Cup on Sunday, 25 January, with kick-off at 15:30.

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